

The Discourse on Analysis

Vibhaṅgasutta (SN 12.2)

Sāvatthiyaṃ viharati.

“Paṭīccasamuppādaṃ vo, bhikkhave, desessāmi vibhajissāmi. Taṃ suṇātha, sādhukaṃ manasi karotha, bhāssissāmi”ti.

Staying near Sāvatthī.

“Monks, I will teach you dependent origination (*paṭīccasamuppāda*) and analyze it for you. Listen, pay close attention, and I will speak.”

“Evaṃ, bhante”ti kho te bhikkhū bhagavato paccassosuṃ. Bhagavā etadavoca:

“Yes, Bhante,” those monks replied to the Blessed One. The Blessed One said this:

“Katamo ca, bhikkhave, paṭīccasamuppādo? Avijjāpaccayā, bhikkhave, saṅkhārā; saṅkhārapaccayā viññāṇaṃ; viññāṇapaccayā nāmarūpaṃ; nāmarūpapaccayā saḷāyatanaṃ; saḷāyatanaṃ paccayā phassa; phassapaccayā vedanā; vedanāpaccayā taṇhā; taṇhāpaccayā upādānaṃ; upādānapaccayā bhava; bhavapaccayā jāti; jātipaccayā jarāmaraṇaṃ sokaparidevadukkhadomanassupāyāsā sambhavanti. Evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa samudayo hoti.

“And what, monks, is dependent origination? With ignorance (*avijjā*) as condition, mental conditioning (*saṅkhāras*) arise; with mental conditioning as condition, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) arises; with consciousness as condition, mind-and-matter (*nāmarūpa*) arises; with mind-and-matter as condition, the six sense doors (*saḷāyatana*) arise; with the six sense doors as condition, contact (*phassa*) arises; with contact as condition, sensations (*vedanās*) arise; with sensations as condition, craving (*taṇhā*) arises; with craving as condition, clinging (*upādāna*) arises; with clinging as condition, becoming (*bhava*) arises; with becoming as condition, birth (*jāti*) arises; with birth as condition, decay and death (*jarāmaraṇa*), sorrow, lamentation, physical pain, mental grief, and despair arise. Thus is the origin of this entire mass of suffering.

Katamañca, bhikkhave, jarāmaraṇaṃ? Yā tesaṃ tesaṃ sattānaṃ tamhi tamhi sattanikāye jarā jīraṇatā khaṇḍiccaṃ pāliccaṃ valittacatā āyuno saṃhāni indriyānaṃ paripāko; ayaṃ vuccati jarā. Yā tesaṃ tesaṃ sattānaṃ tamhā tamhā sattanikāyā cuti cavanatā bhedo antaradhānaṃ maccu maraṇaṃ kālakiriya khandhānaṃ bhedo kaḷavarassa nikkhepo (...), idaṃ vuccati maraṇaṃ. Iti ayañca jarā, idañca maraṇaṃ. Idaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, jarāmaraṇaṃ.

And what, monks, is decay and death? The decay of various beings in their respective categories of beings—their growing old, the breaking of their teeth, the graying of their hair, the wrinkling of their skin, the decline of their life span, and the wearing out of their senses; this is called decay. The passing away of various beings from their respective categories of beings—their falling away, breaking up, disappearance, dying, death, completion of time, the breaking up of the aggregates, and the laying down of the body; this is called death. So this decay and this death are what is called decay and death.

Katamā ca, bhikkhave, jāti? Yā tesam tesam sattānam tamhi tamhi sattanikāye jāti sañjāti okkanti abhinibbatti khandhānam pātubhāvo āyatanānam paṭilābho. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, jāti.

And what, monks, is birth? The birth of various beings in their respective categories of beings—their production, descent, arising, the appearance of the aggregates, and the acquisition of the sense doors. This is called birth.

Katamo ca, bhikkhave, bhavo? Tayome, bhikkhave, bhavā— kāmabhavo, rūpabhavo, arūpabhavo. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, bhavo.

And what, monks, is becoming? There are these three kinds of becoming: sensual becoming (*kāmabhava*), fine-material becoming (*rūpabhava*), and immaterial becoming (*arūpabhava*). This is called becoming.

Katamañca, bhikkhave, upādānam? Cattārimāni, bhikkhave, upādānāni— kāmupādānam, diṭṭhupādānam, sīlabbatupādānam, attavādupādānam. Idaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, upādānam.

And what, monks, is clinging? There are these four kinds of clinging: clinging to sensual pleasures (*kāmupādāna*), clinging to views (*diṭṭhupādāna*), clinging to rules and rituals (*sīlabbatupādāna*), and clinging to a belief in self (*attavādupādāna*). This is called clinging.

Katamā ca, bhikkhave, taṇhā? Chayime, bhikkhave, taṇhākāyā— rūpataṇhā, saddataṇhā, gandhataṇhā, rasataṇhā, phoṭṭhabbatataṇhā, dhammataṇhā. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, taṇhā.

And what, monks, is craving? There are these six groups of craving: craving for sights (*rūpataṇhā*), craving for sounds (*saddataṇhā*), craving for smells (*gandhataṇhā*), craving for tastes (*rasataṇhā*), craving for touches (*phoṭṭhabbatataṇhā*), and craving for thoughts (*dhammataṇhā*). This is called craving.

Katamā ca, bhikkhave, vedanā? Chayime, bhikkhave, vedanākāyā— cakkhusamphassajā vedanā, sotasaṃphassajā vedanā, ghāṇasaṃphassajā

vedanā, jivhāsamphassajā vedanā, kāyasamphassajā vedanā, manosamphassajā vedanā. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, vedanā.

And what, monks, is sensation? There are these six groups of sensations: sensations born of eye-contact (*cakkhusamphassajā vedanā*), sensations born of ear-contact (*sotasamphassajā vedanā*), sensations born of nose-contact (*ghānasamphassajā vedanā*), sensations born of tongue-contact (*jivhāsamphassajā vedanā*), sensations born of body-contact (*kāyasamphassajā vedanā*), and sensations born of mind-contact (*manosamphassajā vedanā*). This is called sensation.

Katamo ca, bhikkhave, phasso? Chayime, bhikkhave, phassakāyā—
cakkhusamphasso, sotasamphasso, ghānasamphasso, jivhāsamphasso,
kāyasamphasso, manosamphasso. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, phasso.

And what, monks, is contact? There are these six groups of contact: eye-contact (*cakkhusamphasso*), ear-contact (*sotasamphasso*), nose-contact (*ghānasamphasso*), tongue-contact (*jivhāsamphasso*), body-contact (*kāyasamphasso*), and mind-contact (*manosamphasso*). This is called contact.

Katamañca, bhikkhave, saḷāyatanaṃ? Cakkhāyatanaṃ, sotāyatanaṃ,
ghānāyatanaṃ, jivhāyatanaṃ, kāyāyatanaṃ, manāyatanaṃ— idaṃ vuccati,
bhikkhave, saḷāyatanaṃ.

And what, monks, are the six sense doors? The eye door (*cakkhāyatana*), ear door (*sotāyatana*), nose door (*ghānāyatana*), tongue door (*jivhāyatana*), body door (*kāyāyatana*), and mind door (*manāyatana*)—these are called the six sense doors.

Katamañca, bhikkhave, nāmarūpaṃ? Vedanā, saññā, cetanā, phasso,
manasikāro— idaṃ vuccati nāmaṃ. Cattāro ca mahābhūtā, catunnañca
mahābhūtānaṃ upādāyarūpaṃ. Idaṃ vuccati rūpaṃ. Iti idaṃca nāmaṃ, idañca
rūpaṃ. Idaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, nāmarūpaṃ.

And what, monks, is mind-and-matter? Sensations (*vedanā*), perception (*saññā*), volition (*cetanā*), contact (*phassa*), and attention (*manasikāra*)—this is called mind (*nāma*). The four primary elements (*mahābhūtā*) and the matter derived from them (*upādāyarūpa*)—this is called matter (*rūpa*). So this is mind and this is matter; this is what is called mind-and-matter.

Katamañca, bhikkhave, viññāṇaṃ? Chayime, bhikkhave, viññāṇakāyā—
cakkhaviññāṇaṃ, sotaviññāṇaṃ, ghānaviññāṇaṃ, jivhāviññāṇaṃ, kāyaviññāṇaṃ,
manoviññāṇaṃ. Idaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, viññāṇaṃ.

And what, monks, is consciousness? There are these six groups of consciousness: eye-consciousness (*cakkhaviññāṇa*), ear-consciousness (*sotaviññāṇa*), nose-consciousness

(*ghānaviññāṇa*), tongue-consciousness (*jivhāviññāṇa*), body-consciousness (*kāyaviññāṇa*), and mind-consciousness (*manoviññāṇa*). This is called consciousness.

Kateme ca, bhikkhave, saṅkhārā? Tayome, bhikkhave, saṅkhārā—kāyasaṅkhāro, vacīsaṅkhāro, cittasaṅkhāro. Ime vuccanti, bhikkhave, saṅkhārā.

And what, monks, is mental conditioning? There are these three kinds of mental conditioning: bodily conditioning (*kāyasaṅkhāra*), verbal conditioning (*vacīsaṅkhāra*), and mental conditioning (*cittasaṅkhāra*). These are called mental conditioning.

Katamā ca, bhikkhave, avijjā? Yaṃ kho, bhikkhave, dukkhe aññāṇaṃ, dukkhasamudaye aññāṇaṃ, dukkhanirodhe aññāṇaṃ, dukkhanirodhagāminiyā paṭipadāya aññāṇaṃ. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, avijjā.

And what, monks, is ignorance? Not knowing suffering (*dukkha*), not knowing the origin of suffering, not knowing the cessation of suffering, and not knowing the path leading to the cessation of suffering. This is called ignorance.

Iti kho, bhikkhave, avijjāpaccayā saṅkhārā;

saṅkhārapaccayā viññāṇaṃ ...pe... evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa samudayo hoti. Avijjāya tveva asesavirāganirodhā saṅkhāranirodho; saṅkhāranirodhā viññāṇanirodho ...pe... evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa nirodho hoti”ti.

“Thus, monks, with ignorance as condition, mental conditioning arises; with mental conditioning as condition, consciousness... and so on... Thus is the origin of this entire mass of suffering. But with the complete fading away and cessation of ignorance, mental conditioning ceases; with the cessation of mental conditioning, consciousness ceases... and so on... Thus is the cessation of this entire mass of suffering.”

Dutiyam.

(Second)

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
paṭiccasamuppāda	paṭiccasamuppāda	dependent origination	The Discourse on Analysis	The law of cause and effect, explaining how the entire cycle of suffering arises and ceases.
avijjā	avijjā	ignorance	The Discourse on Analysis	Lack of experiential understanding of the Four Noble Truths.
saṅkhāra	saṅkhāra	mental conditioning	The Discourse on Analysis	Mental reactions and conditioning that accumulate and drive the cycle of existence.
viññāṇa	viññāṇa	consciousness	The Discourse on Analysis	The cognitive aspect of the mind that notes the presence of an object.
nāmarūpa	nāmarūpa	mind-and-matter	The Discourse on Analysis	The interactive combination of mental and physical components of existence.
saḷāyatana	saḷāyatana	six sense doors	The Discourse on Analysis	The six internal organs of reception

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				through which contact occurs (eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, mind).
phassa	phassa	contact	The Discourse on Analysis	The meeting of sense door, sense object, and consciousness.
vedanā	vedanā	sensations	The Discourse on Analysis	The somatic experience of physical sensations on the body.
taṇhā	taṇhā	craving	The Discourse on Analysis	The reaction of liking/wanting that arises due to sensations.
upādāna	upādāna	clinging	The Discourse on Analysis	Intense attachment or grasping that grows out of craving.
bhava	bhava	becoming	The Discourse on Analysis	The process of active existence and accumulation of karmic force.
jāti	jāti	birth	The Discourse on Analysis	Rebirth or arising of new states of existence.

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
jarāmarāṇa	jarāmarāṇa	decay and death	The Discourse on Analysis	The inevitable disintegration and end of conditioned states.
cetanā	cetanā	volition	The Discourse on Analysis	The mental factor of intention or will.
manasikāra	manasikāra	attention	The Discourse on Analysis	The mind's focusing or paying attention to an object.
mahābhūtā	mahābhūtā	primary elements	The Discourse on Analysis	The four basic elements of matter (earth, water, fire, wind).
upādāyarūpa	upādāyarūpa	derived matter	The Discourse on Analysis	Secondary physical phenomena dependent on the four primary elements.

Translator Notes

1. **Intimate Teacher-to-Student Voice:** The English translation maintains a direct and experiential tone, matching Goenkaji's spoken style.
2. **Mind-and-Matter (nāmarūpa):** Translated as "mind-and-matter" in accordance with the target language profile's guidelines. Inside *nāma*, we specify the mental aggregates (*vedanā*, *saññā*, *cetanā*, *phassa*, *manasikāra*) and distinguish them from the physical aggregate (*rūpa*).
3. **Six Sense Doors (saḷāyatana):** Rendered as "six sense doors" to highlight their function in meditation as the contact points where sensations (*vedanā*) arise.

4. **Sense-Contact Sensations:** Maintained strict grammatical parallelism in translating the six categories of sensations (*cakkhusamphassajā vedanā*), craving, and contact, illustrating the chain of dependent origination.